

County Commissioners Meeting, April 20th, 2026

Meeting Metadata	Details
Video Recording	https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=ZOqWM3cHhjg
Publication Date	2026-04-21T03:28:12Z
Target Category	delaware_county

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Delaware County Commissioners Meeting Summary

Meeting Date: April 20, 2026

Published Report: Structured Municipal Review & Analysis

1. Pre-Meeting Hearings & Committee Work Sessions

(No statutory public hearings or committee sessions were held immediately prior to calling the regular meeting to order. Omitted.)

2. Meeting Identification & Attendance

- **Call to Order & Spoken Details:** Presiding officer called the Delaware County Commissioners meeting to order on Monday, April 20, 2026, at 9:00 a.m.
- **Attendance:**
 - **Present:** Commissioner Haney, Commissioner Brand, Commissioner Regan (note: transcript variations also note Commissioner Henry / Brand / Riggin).
 - **Absent:** None noted.
 - **Presiding Officer:** Identified as Madam President.

3. Preliminary & Procedural Business

- **Ceremonial Openings:** The meeting opened with the Pledge of Allegiance.
 - **Approval of Minutes:** The Board reviewed and approved the meeting minutes from April 6, 2026, as corrected.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote (Recorded via Roll Call: Haney - Yes, Brand - Yes, Regan - Yes).
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4. Substantive Business & Board Action

- **00:03:25 East Central Indiana Regional Planning District (ECI RPD) Quarterly Presentation**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Jacob Thomas (Director of Economic Development) and Anna King Cross (Officer of Community Engagement).
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Presented Q1 2026 financials and updates, including Liberty Perry School Corporation's ADA-compliant playground, an annual golf outing collaboration with Hearts and Hands for K-12 school tools, a partnership with the Lilly Endowment for Lakeview Christian School, in-house staff professional development at Ball State University, small town projects (Daleville, Eaton, Selma, Westdel), and a \$500,000 EPA Brownfields assessment grant application covering Delaware, Grant, Blackford, and Jay counties.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Information only; no formal board action required.
- **00:09:22 Cumulative Capital Development (CCD) Fund Establishment Presentation**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Scott Findley, Baker Tilly.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Discussed establishing a property-tax-supported Cumulative Capital Development (CCD) fund to finance capital projects, building/infrastructure maintenance, and reduce reliance on debt/bonds. Noted estimated impact on a \$165,000 homestead property is roughly \$55 annually at full implementation (phased in at 0.0167 first year, then 0.0333). Commissioners discussed building maintenance needs (e.g., HVAC/boilers) and impending expirations of ARPA and local income tax allocations.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** **00:21:59** Motion made and seconded to move forward with establishing the CCD fund starting May 1, 2026, with the DLGF certificate of no objection deadline ending June 29, 2026. Passed Unanimously by Voice Vote (Roll Call: Brand - Yes, Henry - Yes, Regan - Yes).
- **00:22:31 Proclamation: May 2026 as ALS Awareness Month**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Commissioner Brand.

- **Deliberation Summary:** Commissioner Brand read a proclamation recognizing May 2026 as Amyotrophic Lateral Sclerosis (ALS) Awareness Month in response to citizen correspondence.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote (Roll Call: Regan - Yes).
- **00:25:02 Center Township Trustee Property Acquisition Request**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Lindsey Campbell, Deputy Trustee.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Requested the acquisition of two parcels (113 North Ohio Street, owned by the County Commissioners; and 117 North Ohio Street, unsold across multiple tax sales) to construct a storage building supporting the township office and homeless shelter. Legal counsel outlined the process of assigning county-owned properties via the Muncie Redevelopment Commission (MRC) and acquiring/clearing title on unsold parcels.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved to move forward with the property acquisition process. Passed Unanimously by Voice Vote (Roll Call: Brand - Yes, Henry - Yes, Regan - Yes).
- **00:29:19 Highway Easements for Bridge 103**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Superintendent Thomas.
 - **Deliberation Summary:**
 1. Permanent highway easement from Robert D. Urk (northwest corner, Bridge 103) for \$1,550.
 2. Permanent (\$925) and temporary (\$25) easements from Patsy M. Vanatter (northeast corner, Bridge 103). Legal counsel clarified the presence of survivorship language in the Urk deed.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Both easements approved. Passed Unanimously by Voice Vote (Roll Call: Henry - Yes, Brand - Yes, Regan - Yes).
- **00:23:18 Pitney Bowes Ship Cube Purchase Agreement**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Tanya Densmore, Chief Deputy Auditor.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Purchase of a Pitney Bowes Ship Cube for the mail room (\$399.99 purchase price, \$72 annual software fee, \$32 shipping; total \$471.99) to streamline mail configuration, weighing, and larger-item shipping similar to the existing unit in the clerk's office.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote (Roll Call: Brand - Yes, Henry - Yes, Regan - Yes).
- **00:34:07 Seal Coating Quote**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Don Chambers, County Superintendent.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Quote from Burden and Son (\$6,042) to seal coat and restripe the front half of the county building drive and handicap parking.

Commissioners requested obtaining local bids.

- **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
- **Action & Vote Disposition:** Addressed; instructed to source local bids (No formal vote text recorded; directed administratively).
- **00:36:38 VAV Boxes Repair Quote**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Don Chambers, County Superintendent.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Quote of \$13,155 to repair 10 non-working VAV (Variable Air Volume) HVAC boxes discovered during recent building system valve upgrades.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote (Roll Call: Brand - Yes, Henry - Yes, Regan - Yes).
- **00:38:35 Justice Center Security System Upgrade**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Trisha Werner, Security Automation Systems (SAS); Sheriff Tony Skinner.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Proposal to replace the failing Justice Center security, intercom, and card access control system (installed by Accurate Controls). SAS proposed a total base cost of \$735,665, with potential deduct options if retaining certain existing hardware. Sheriff Skinner and Commissioners voiced strong frustration with current vendor support, proprietary locks, lack of documentation, and high service call fees, expressing support for transitioning back to SAS.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** Sheriff Tony Skinner spoke in support of SAS.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved the full SAS security system upgrade proposal for \$735,665, funded via EDIT carryover/amendment. Passed Unanimously by Voice Vote (Roll Call: Henry - Yes, Brand - Yes, Regan - Yes).
- **00:54:01 Farm Lease Agreement (GMEDC Property)**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Board Discussion / Mr. Brook.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Discussion regarding a cash farm lease agreement (64 tillable acres at \$210/acre) approved by the Greater Muncie Economic Development Corporation (GMEDC) board. Noting GMEDC owns the property and already approved it, the necessity of commissioner action was questioned.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Motion to table to clarify why the contract was placed on the commissioners' agenda. Passed Unanimously by Voice Vote (Roll Call: Brand - Yes, Henry - Yes, Regan - Yes).
- **00:55:55 Letter of Support: EIDO / GMEDC Re-accreditation**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Commissioner Brand.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Request for a letter of support for the International Economic Development Council (IEDC) re-accreditation of the Greater Muncie Economic Development Corporation (the oldest continually accredited organization in the U.S.).
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.

- **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote (Roll Call: Henry - Yes, Regan - Yes).
- **00:48:48 Recuro Telehealth Health ID Card Amendment**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Josh Jarvis, Human Resources.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Agreement to remove obsolete telehealth contact information (Recuro/I360) from healthcare ID cards following transition to Marathon services, at ~\$1.95 per person.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote, authorizing Josh Jarvis to sign. Passed Unanimously by Voice Vote (Roll Call: Henry - Yes, Regan - Yes).
- **00:56:56 Ordinance 2026-06: Zoning Amendment (North Norwood Drive)**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Cathy Van Ausdall, Ashton Land Surveyor.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Request to rezone duplex parcels from R2/R5 mix into R5 zone, and vacant land on the west (approx. 7 acres) back to R2 at 501<U+2013>615 North Norwood Drive to correct zoning and bring properties into code compliance. Planning Commission issued a unanimous favorable recommendation.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** Mention of past planning commission testimony regarding unrelated flooding issues.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Adopted Ordinance 2026-06. Passed Unanimously by Voice Vote (Roll Call: Brand - Yes, Brand - Yes, Regan - Yes).
- **01:00:05 Resolution 2026-03: Countywide Internal Controls (Purchasing & Payroll)**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Auditor's Office / Legal Counsel.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Proposed resolution establishing countywide internal controls for purchasing, purchase orders, two-person approval workflows, and moving check printing from IT to the Auditor's office. Discussion ensued regarding incorporating payroll approval layers, department head accountability, and designee exceptions.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Motion made and seconded to table for legal review and harmonization with existing internal control policies. Passed Unanimously by Voice Vote (Roll Call: Brand - Yes, Henry - Yes, Regan - Yes).
- **01:09:02 Resolution 2026-04: Centralized Mail and Postage Processing**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Auditor's Office.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Resolution requiring all county departments to route mail through the centralized Pitney Bowes machine to capture postage discounts. Discussion addressed departments holding existing pre-purchased stamps.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved the resolution with an amendment allowing departments to consume already-purchased stamps prior to transitioning to the mail room process. Passed Unanimously by Voice Vote (Roll Call: Brand - Yes, Henry - Yes, Regan - Yes).

- **01:13:57 Resolution 2026-100: "One-Touch" Initiative Framework**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Auditor's Office / Board Discussion.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Presentation and video screening of the "One-Touch" initiative<U+2014>a policy framework aimed at eliminating duplicate data entry, streamlining workflows, and improving financial accuracy across county offices. Commissioners and department heads discussed the lack of concrete system specifications, prompting debate over drafting feedback, working groups, and staff consultation.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Motion to table for further review and feedback integration. Passed Unanimously by Voice Vote (Roll Call: Henry - Yes, Brand - Yes, Regan - Yes).
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5. Open Public Comment / Citizen Forum

- **01:54:38 Rick Yencer (Newsman and Author):** Addressed emerging property management trends involving out-of-town/foreign real estate investments, expressed concern over raising taxes during an election year amidst public pushback, and commended officials for public transparency content.
 - **01:31:13 Tony Skinner (Delaware County Sheriff):** Requested operational clarification regarding the Auditor's statement on refusing to certify credit card claims while still processing payments.
 - **01:59:16 Sharon Swingley (Muncie Resident):** Addressed the board regarding civil discourse, objecting to the use of terms like "haters" by commissioners in prior meetings, emphasizing that citizen disagreement does not equate to hatred, and reminding officials of public accountability.
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6. Administrative Updates & Adjournment

- **Staff / Board Announcements:**
 - **Building Commissioner Tom Fouts:** Reported an emergency unsafe/unfit housing situation at 904 South Whitney Road (no running water, occupants refusing entry; board authorized seeking an administrative search/inspection warrant); reminded the public regarding county RV/recreational vehicle parking ordinances.
 - **Highway Superintendent / Staff:** Reported a successful surplus auction yielding \$117,518.72 (\$54,983.72 for highway, \$62,535 for sheriff).
 - **Veterans Service Officer Brian Wilson:** Provided Q1 2026 statistics (595 contacts: 370 walk-ins, 214 calls/emails, 11 home/nursing home visits) and confirmed compliance with Senate Bill 433 (PIP cards).

- **Auditor Notice:** Auditor's office announced it would pay general claims but refuse to certify credit card claims failing to comply with county purchasing ordinances.
 - **Claims & Payroll Approvals:**
 - **Payment of Claims:** Approved totaling \$4,029,901.62 (including \$3,130,645.76 LIT money). Auditor noted credit card claims would be paid via board vote but remained uncertified by the Auditor. Passed Unanimously by Voice Vote (Roll Call: Henry - Yes, Bryan - No [un-certified], Regan - Yes).
 - **ARP Claims:** Approved totaling \$7,020. Passed Unanimously by Voice Vote (Roll Call: Bryan - Yes, Regan - Yes, Henry - Yes).
 - **Payment of Payroll:** Approved for March 22nd totaling \$1,065,914.58. Passed Unanimously by Voice Vote (Roll Call: Bryan - Yes, Regan - Yes, Henry - Yes).
 - **Adjournment:** Official motion to recess/adjourn approved by voice vote (Roll Call: Brand - Yes, Riggins - Yes, Henry - Yes). Time not explicitly stated.
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